

SECURITY WATCH

iOS 11

Many of you will have started getting the iOS 11 update notification for your iOS devices. Many of you will also be waiting for your favourite apps to be updated first before taking the plunge into an all new iOS version. Don't. iOS 11 is not just a whole new OS version and one with significant changes for the iPad, it's actually also a whole lot of bug fixing of vulnerabilities in the older iOS 10 version. Now that iOS 11 is out, all of the people who found the vulnerabilities (and many will be from security companies), will now rush to publish and take credit for their finds. This means that hackers will now know where to look and what to look for, and sitting with an iOS 10 device is as good as having a target on your back. Do without the straggler apps, stay safe first.

The Pirate Bay = bad

No, this isn't some guilt trip about not pirating, or telling you to watch (ugh) Indie movies instead of pirated Hollywood blockbusters. This is about your favourite torrent aggregator site doing something nefarious without telling you. It's not a security threat per se, but it can still cause your CPU and RAM usage to spike, which can cause other software to become unstable.

Visitors to the Pirate Bay site knew something was fishy when their systems started acting sluggish. Some users dug into the source code of the site and found that the site was loading and running a cryptocurrency miner into their browsers. Users were reporting CPU usage of over 80% with just one browser window open. Turns out the guys at Pirate Bay were "testing" an alternate way to generate revenue, in an effort to get rid of all the ads. It's sneaky of them, and it irritated a lot of the regulars of the site. What do you think? Is it OK for a site to run a miner in your browser as a way to earn revenue?

APP WATCH

Tez



In Hindi Tez means "fast" and that's what Google is hoping for with their new mobile payment app made specifically for India. The app is available for download on iOS and Android and supports English, Hindi, Bengali, Gujarati, Kannada, Marathi, Tamil, and Telugu languages. The app is powered by the UPI payment protocol. Tez works with all major banks, including Axis, HDFC Bank, ICICI and State Bank of India.

Google's obviously hoping that it will be able to capture a large market



share quickly, because it is an app from a trusted source. It makes sense, because people are more likely to trust a giant like Google with their money, and more importantly trust that Google has all the necessary security in place.

Although it's still in its early days, and Google doesn't have too many partners just yet... it's Google... so we expect them to go at it in a big way. For now, it might be good to get on to the app early, as Google tries to woo new users with freebies and giveaways. For example, they're claiming to give away 1 lakh every week to one lucky user, every Sunday; no coupons, no secret codes and sharing of links, etc, just install the app and you might win! The app is available for Android and iOS.

Stop Motion Studio



Stop Motion Studio is an easy to use app that will allow you to make your own stop motion movies. How good or bad those movies turn out depends only on your creativity. All you need is a camera phone and a tripod of some kind. Remember to send us your movies!

GlassWire Data Monitor



This is a data monitoring app for Android phones which will help you keep a close eye on your usage. You also get a clean interface with all your apps listed, and GlassWire tells you which app used how much data across various selectable time periods. A good app for data paranoid folk.

Firefox Focus



For all you paranoid folk out there who want internet access, but want to pretend you're living off the grid... Firefox Focus is the ideal browser! It automatically blocks a wide range of web trackers, including social media widgets and the like. Recently launched on Android.